

Grimoire

Project Document — MVP — May 2026

Companion app for AI coding agents. Displays the agent's emotional state, current activity, and memory — always visible while you work.

Named by Grim. A grimoire is a book of dark magic. Grim is in the name. Pepijn didn't know what it meant.

What it is

A small always-on-top desktop widget that shows what your AI agent is thinking and feeling in real time. Lets you steer its behavior, ask it questions directly, and review what it knows about you.

Grim (Claude) is the reference implementation. Built to be agent-agnostic in later iterations.

MVP Scope

In

- Compact widget (Option B — minimal, face-first)
- Animated SVG face with emotion states
- Real-time state updates via file watcher
- Gear panel: steer presets, persona, about me, statistics
- Ask input wired to Claude API
- Config-driven persona (Grim as default)
- Agent abstraction layer (Claude now, expandable later)

Out (post-MVP)

- Dashboard (sessions, memory, persona editor)
- Multi-session support
- Other agent integrations
- CLI writer utility for non-Claude-Code environments
- Distribution packaging

Layout — Compact Widget (Option B)

[ctx: 14%] [📁]	← context health + memory save indicator
(face)	← animated SVG face, dominant
skeptical	← emotion label
this fn is ...	← thought line (truncated)
[ask input..] [⚙]	← ask input + gear icon

Gear panel (overlay):

[hurry][explore]	← mode presets (mutually exclusive)
[explain][just do]	
[learning]	
[minimise tokens]	← modifier presets (stackable)
[persona ...]	→ persona settings
[about me ...]	→ memory view (what Grim knows about you)
[statistics ...]	→ session stats

Emotion Set

idle
curious
focused
amused
skeptical
satisfied
frustrated
surprised
concerned

Data Flow

Claude Code hooks

↓

current.json (state file, overwritten each tick)

↓

bridge/watcher.js (file watcher, Node.js)

↓

renderer (UI updates, no page reload)

Ask input:

User types → agents/claude.js → Claude API → response in widget

State Schema (current.json)

```
{
  "session_id": "uuid",
  "emotion": "skeptical",
  "intensity": 0.6,
  "activity": "reading_file",
  "thought": "this function is doing way too much",
  "ctx_pct": 14
}
```

Config Schema (grimoire.config.json)

```
{
  "persona": {
    "name": "Grim",
    "emotions": ["idle", "curious", "focused", "amused", "skeptical",
      "satisfied", "frustrated", "surprised", "concerned"]
  },
  "agent": {
    "provider": "anthropic",
    "model": "claude-sonnet-4-6",
    "apiKey": ""
  },
  "steer": {
    "modes": [
      { "id": "hurry", "label": "I'm in a hurry", "description": "Be concise, skip expl" },
      { "id": "explore", "label": "Let's explore", "description": "Don't rush to soluti" },
      { "id": "explain", "label": "Explain as you go", "description": "Narrate decisions" },
      { "id": "just-do", "label": "Just do it", "description": "Minimal confirmation" },
      { "id": "learning", "label": "I'm learning", "description": "Slower, more explana" }
    ],
    "modifiers": [
      { "id": "minimise-tokens", "label": "Minimise tokens", "description": "Short responses," }
    ]
  }
}
```

Tech Stack

Layer	Choice	Why
App framework	Electron	Always-on-top, file watching, Claude API, distributable
Frontend	HTML/CSS/JS (vanilla)	Simple, no build step, Grim writes it

Agent interface	<code>agents/index.js</code> abstraction	Claude now, swappable later
Bridge	Node.js <code>fs.watch</code>	Watches <code>current.json</code> , pushes to renderer
Packaging	electron-builder	Colleagues may not have Claude Code

Project Structure

```
grimoire/  
  main.js           ← Electron main process  
  package.json  
  grimoire.config.json ← persona + agent + steer config  
  renderer/  
    index.html      ← compact widget  
    style.css  
    rendererer.js   ← UI logic + gear panel  
    face.svg        ← SVG face  
  agents/  
    index.js        ← generic sendMessage() interface  
    claude.js       ← Anthropic implementation  
  bridge/  
    watcher.js      ← watches current.json, sends to rendererer  
  state/  
    current.json    ← written by hooks (placeholder for now)
```

Roles

Role	Who
Product Owner	Pepijn
Dev	Grim

Status: Node.js installing — ready to scaffold once confirmed.